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Submitter Information

Name: Ethan Stanley

Address:

General Comment

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I have done work in the illustration industry, and AI has negatively impacted my livelihood because it seeks to ignore copyright to "learn" from my work to mimic and ultimately replace me. I have seen AIs that have been trained to mimic specific human artists so closely that they even mimic the artists' signatures. Without safeguards, AI will negatively affect all creative industries including writing, illustration, music, acting, video, and more.

The current generation of AI is overhyped. It is massively expensive in terms of both money and energy, like one of the newest AI can cost over \$1000 per task [1]. It is prone to errors like depicting hands with extra fingers, telling users to eat rocks [2], or trying to convince companies to hire people just because they're named Jared and played lacrosse [3]. A lawyer used AI to make court documents, and it made a completely fictitious legal history [4]. The current generation of AI is not designed to be right, only to look and sound right. It can be completely wrong while assuring you (or even arguing with you) that it is completely right. The future of America cannot be built on ridiculously expensive lying machines.

AI advancements must come ethically. The current generation of AI depends upon human-created works to learn from, but if "barriers" are removed it will massively discourage further human works and innovation. Who would take hours to create something if they know that it would just be absorbed by a dozen AIs? AIs must respect copyright. They must require human workers to opt in to contributing their works. Allowing human workers to opt out is unacceptable because there are numerous AIs and more every day, so opting out of every single AI one by one would be a never-ending task. AI works must be labeled as such to help protect people from misinformation (like eating rocks or poisonous mushrooms [5]) and to ensure that people know what they are really paying for (like AI books that misidentify mushrooms).

Even ignoring the economic and employment impacts, the current generation of AI depends upon human-created works to be the backbone of their data. AI models can break down when they are trained using works created by other AIs [6]. AI works are flooding websites and search engine results and making it hard to tell what is real and accurate. Even AIs need protection from other AIs.

[1] <https://futurism.com/the-byte/openai-o3-cost-per-query>

[2] <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cd11gzejgz4o>

[3] <https://qz.com/1427621/companies-are-on-the-hook-if-their-hiring-algorithms-are-biased>

[4] <https://apnews.com/article/artificial-intelligence-chatgpt-fake-case-lawyers-d6ae9fa79d0542db9e1455397aef381c>

[5] <https://www.techtimes.com/articles/295863/20230901/beware-ai-written-mushroom-foraging-guides-amazon-experts-warn.htm>

[6] <https://techcrunch.com/2024/07/24/model-collapse-scientists-warn-against-letting-ai-eat-its-own-tail/>

Thank you.